

BLU-RAY HOME THEATRE SYSTEMS

There is a wide range of Blu-ray home theatre systems to choose from. It all depends on how much space you can allocate and how much you are willing to spend



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Surprisingly, Blu-ray home theatre systems are not being advertised so much in India but are available in the market, nevertheless. During an evening stroll in three adjacent malls in Delhi I came across quite a few Blu-ray disc players, which can make the centre-piece for a good home theatre system along with an LCD or LED TV—if you want to add one to your system.

The brands selling home theatre systems that I have come across re-

cently include Bose, Sony, Panasonic and Samsung. But there could be many more brands available elsewhere in India. Most are offering 2D disc players though there are some offering 3D players as well, such as Samsung's BD-D5500 3D player. Incidentally, Bose is selling home theatre systems with DVD players and not Blu-ray disc players.

All you need to add to the Blu-ray player is some matching speakers to make a complete audio home theatre system. Generally, these speakers have to be attached to the player with wires. However, wireless speaker systems also have now started appearing in

market. But these are much costlier. Of course, you may add a radio tuner too to your system—if you like.

Every brand seems to be offering several models of players or complete systems, but most showrooms have only one or two brands to show. Except the Bose showroom that had four models (of DVD players) on display. So I decided to do some desk research as well to find out what all is available to select from, and how to select a suitable system.

Selecting a system

Actually you don't need a Blu-ray system if you are building an audio home theatre only, and not a video system to enjoy movies. But Blu-ray players are now available at a reasonable price. So why not go for them straightaway as these can play almost all kinds of CDs and DVDs too. And later, if you wish to add an LCD or LED TV to your system, you won't have to buy another player.

There is now a wide choice of Blu-ray CD players available, starting at around Rs 9000—thanks to the increasing popularity of LCD and LED TV systems. Essentially, every TV brand is now offering its own Blu-ray players. If you don't want to go in for another TV yet, you may just buy the Blu-ray disc player. Even additional speakers are not necessary, if you are content with the stereophonic sound from your present TV set. Of course then you will not have a home theatre but only a stereo system.

So, as you may see now, there is a wide choice before you. It all depends on how much space you can allocate